DEADLINE: FORTEAN

MICRO EURO CRYPTID JOURNALISM GAME • COMPLETE FIELD GUIDE

PLAYERS: 2 – 4
PLAYTIME: 15 – 20 MINS

I. GAME OVERVIEW

You are rival photojournalists investigating bizarre cryptid sightings. Your goal is to capture sufficient photo evidence for front-page headlines without over-investigating: **if you look too closely, you debunk the myth as mundane!**

II. SETUP

1. Shuffle the **9 Location Cards** and place 3 active locations face-up in the center.
2. Each player selects 1 **Tabloid Role Card** and receives 5 **Camera Shot Tokens (1, 2, 3, 4, 5)**.
3. Place Prestige VP tokens in a central bank.

III. GAMEPLAY STRUCTURE (3 ROUNDS)

- **Phase 1 (Taking Shots):** Players take turns placing 1 face-down Shot Token under any active location until each player has assigned 3 tokens.
- **Phase 2 (Exposure Resolution):** Flip all tokens under each location and sum their values.

IV. DYNAMIC SCALING RULE

- **2 Players:** Use Base Bust Limit.
- **3 Players:** Base Limit + 2.
- **4 Players:** Base Limit + 4.

V. RESOLVING LOCATIONS

- **Below Min Requirement:** Exposure too dark/blurry. Story cannot be printed!
- **Sweet Spot (Min to Scaled Bust Limit - 1):** SCOOP PUBLISHED!
  - Highest single Shot Token wins **1st Place Scoop VP**.
  - 2nd highest single Shot Token wins **2nd Place Scoop VP**.
- **At or Above Scaled Bust Limit:** MYTH BUSTED! The photo was over-exposed, proving the cryptid is mundane! The single highest contributor loses **-2 VP**.

VI. PLAYSTYLE SCENARIOS

- **Aggressive Hounds:** Pushing high tokens (4s/5s) risks triggering busts, but captures 1st place when successful.
- **Cautious Interns:** Playing low tokens (1s/2s) stays safe, but risks failing min requirements.
- **Saboteurs:** Adding tokens to opponent locations to deliberately exceed the Bust Limit and cause -2 VP penalties.

VII. VICTORY

After 3 rounds (investigating all 9 locations), the journalist with the most Prestige Victory Points wins!

FORTEAN

MISTY LAKE

MIN REQ: 4
BASE BUST: ≥ 8
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:3p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
The Serpent of the Deeps

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
A mossy, submerged tree trunk swaying in currents.

CARD #1 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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BLACKWOOD FOREST

MIN REQ: 3
BASE BUST: ≥ 7
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:3p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
The Winged Cryptid

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
A screech owl roosting in an old weather-beaten barn.

CARD #2 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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ABANDONED ASYLUM

MIN REQ: 5
BASE BUST: ≥ 9
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:4p | 2nd:2p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Poltergeist of Ward 4

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
A loose canvas tarpaulin flapping against broken glass.

CARD #3 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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OLD GRAIN SILO

MIN REQ: 3
BASE BUST: ≥ 6
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:2p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Alien Circle Marker

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
High-voltage searchlights reflecting off low fog.

CARD #4 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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DESERT HIGHWAY

MIN REQ: 4
BASE BUST: ≥ 7
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:3p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
The Stray Chupacabra

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
A feral stray dog afflicted with severe mange.

CARD #5 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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FOGGY PIER

MIN REQ: 2
BASE BUST: ≥ 5
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:2p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Ghost Ship Captain

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
An old rusted bell buoy clanging in heavy tide.

CARD #6 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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PINE BARRENS

MIN REQ: 5
BASE BUST: ≥ 8
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:4p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Devil's Hoofprints

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
Melting snow patterns over active mole tunnels.

CARD #7 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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SUBURBAN ATTIC

MIN REQ: 2
BASE BUST: ≥ 6
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:2p | 2nd:1p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Whispering Shadow

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
A dusty vibrating motor in an ancient air filter.

CARD #8 DEADLINE: FORTEAN

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RADIO TOWER

MIN REQ: 6
BASE BUST: ≥ 10
+2 per extra player > 2
SCOOP: 1st:5p | 2nd:2p

MYTH SIGHTING:
Secret Signal Station

TRUTH (IF BUSTED):
Static bleed-through from an outdated ham radio setup.

CARD #9 DEADLINE: FORTEAN